

SOCIOLOGY 101 · RECITATION HOMEWORK

Homework 1: Who Works in a NICU?

Name: _____

Date: _____

Instructions: About 20 minutes. Sociology is about groups – so several questions ask you to look at the groups in your own life, too. Total: **21 points**.

Part A — Match the team member to the job

1. Draw a line from each NICU team member to what they mostly do. (6 pts)

Neonatologist	Helps mothers pump and provide breast milk
NICU nurse	Leads the medical plan and makes the big decisions on rounds
Respiratory therapist	Supports the family – housing, money worries, stress, paperwork
Pharmacist	Runs the ventilators and CPAP and helps at deliveries
Lactation consultant	Cares for the baby at the bedside hour after hour
Social worker	Prepares TPN recipes and checks every medicine dose

Part B — Your own society

2. Draw a chart of a group you belong to – your household, your classroom, or a team. Put each person (or role) in a box and write one job they have in the group. Draw lines between people who work together directly. (2 pts)

Part C — Which level of care?

3. Write the level of newborn unit (I, II, III, or IV) that fits each baby. (4 pts)

Baby	Level
A healthy baby born at 40 weeks who just needs checks and feeding	
A baby born at 34 weeks who needs a little help staying warm and learning to feed	
A baby born at 26 weeks who needs a ventilator and TPN	
A baby who needs an operation to repair a complex heart defect	

Part D — Short answers

4. Why is the person who cleans the NICU part of the care team? Use the word infection in your answer. (2 pts)

5. In your own words, what does regionalization of newborn care mean? (1 pt)

6. Why do morning rounds follow the same order every day? (1 pt)

- ☐ A. So nothing gets skipped and everyone knows when to speak.
- ☐ B. So the attending can leave the unit sooner.
- ☐ C. So the babies all sleep at the same time.
- ☐ D. So parents don't interrupt with questions.

Part E — Flashback

7. From NICU Tutor: what are “rounds”? (1 pt)

8. From NICU Tutor: a pulse oximeter alarm goes off. What does a good nurse do FIRST, and why? (1 pt)

Part F — Think like a doctor

9. A new nurse notices a baby's color looks wrong, but the senior doctor has just said the baby is fine and moved on. What should the team's culture be so that the baby is safe — and why does that matter more than who is senior? (3 pts)

Score: _____ / 21 points

Professor's comment:
